Ticket 3

TCK03-Onboard

Summary

Category	Account management
Request	New hire in Sales needs a domain account and access to the Sales share
Employee	Liam Harris, Sales Associate, reporting to Alice Carter
Action	Create the account in the right OU, add the department group, fill in the directory details, verify access
Tools	Active Directory Users and Computers (ADUC), PowerShell
Outcome	Resolved. The user signed in, set his own password, can open the Sales share and is blocked from the Finance share

Problem

A new hire in Sales, Liam Harris (Sales Associate, reporting to Alice Carter), needs a domain account and access to the Sales share.

Background: what onboarding controls. Two decisions made during onboarding control everything the new hire gets:

- **OU placement** decides which **policies** apply to the account.
- **Group membership** decides what the account can **access**.

A mistake in either direction is a problem: the user can't work on day one, or they get access they shouldn't have. The aim is **least privilege**: exactly what the role needs and nothing more.

Environment

Details used for this account

Item	Value
Full name	Liam Harris
Logon name	`lharris` (convention: first initial + surname, lowercase)
OU	`Acme / Users / Sales`
Department / title	Sales / Sales Associate
Manager	Alice Carter
Group	`GRP-Sales`
Account expiry	None (permanent employee)

Naming rules: the logon name must be unique across the whole domain, the full name must be unique within its OU, and the pre-Windows 2000 name is limited to 20 characters. A clash is handled with a variant such as `lharris2`.

Domain: acme.local. File server: WIN-4G8SQK9BMC1 (shares Sales and Finance). Tools: ADUC, PowerShell.

Troubleshooting Steps

#	Action	Result
1	In ADUC, right-click the **Sales** OU → **New** → **User**. Check the line at the top of the wizard before continuing.	Create in: `acme.local/Acme/Users/Sales`. Names and logon name entered.
2	Password page: a random temporary password was generated with PowerShell (hidden in the screenshot) and entered twice. **User must change password at next logon** is ticked. **Password never expires** is left unticked, and the account is enabled.	Only the user ever knows his real password.
3	Summary page before clicking Finish.	Shows full name, logon name and forced password change.
4	User **Properties** → **Member Of** tab → **Add** → `GRP-Sales`.	Member of Domain Users and GRP-Sales.
5	**Organization** tab: job title, department, company, and manager. Click **OK** to save.	Details saved (Apply greyed out, nothing pending).
6	Verify in AD with `Get-ADUser` and `Get-ADPrincipalGroupMembership`.	User and group membership as expected (see Verification).
7	Client: first sign-in with the temporary password.	Windows refuses to continue until a new password is set.
8	Client: user enters the old (temporary) password, then chooses and confirms a new one. Support never sees it.	Password changed by the user.
9	Client: `whoami /groups`.	`ACME\GRP-Sales` is listed, and no other department group.
10	Positive test: Win+R → `\\WIN-4G8SQK9BMC1\Sales`.	The folder opens. It is empty in this environment, but the point is that access is granted.
11	Negative test: Win+R → `\\WIN-4G8SQK9BMC1\Finance`.	Windows reports that the user does not have permission.

Add the department group. `Domain Users` is added automatically to every new account. `GRP-Sales` has to be added by hand. Being in the Sales **OU** does not make a user a member of the Sales **group**. They are separate structures. No other group is added. Anything beyond the department baseline needs the manager's approval, recorded in the ticket.

Directory details. The wizard doesn't collect job title, department, company and manager, so they stay empty unless entered by hand. They feed address books, reports, and approval chains. Closing the window without clicking **OK** discards the changes. The greyed-out **Apply** button in the screenshot shows nothing is pending.

Proving what a user **can't** reach is as important as proving what they can. The Finance result is also the correct kind of error. A message about the name or path not being found would point to a DNS or network fault instead of a permission result.

Root Cause

Not a fault: Liam Harris, a new hire, had no domain account. Everything he receives is decided by OU placement (policies) and group membership (access). **Why the share results differ:** when the user signs in, Windows builds an access token listing his groups. The file server compares that token with each share's permission list. The Sales share allows `GRP-Sales`, which he belongs to. The Finance share allows only `GRP-Finance`, which he doesn't.

Fix

Create the account in the Sales OU with a random temporary password and forced change at next logon, add GRP-Sales, and fill in the Organization details (see Troubleshooting Steps). The temporary password was generated with:

```
Add-Type -AssemblyName System.Web
[System.Web.Security.Membership]::GeneratePassword(12,3)
```

PowerShell equivalent

```
$pw = Read-Host -AsSecureString "Temp password"
New-ADUser -Name "Liam Harris" -GivenName Liam -Surname Harris `
  -SamAccountName lharris -UserPrincipalName lharris@acme.local `
  -Path "OU=Sales,OU=Users,OU=Acme,DC=acme,DC=local" `
  -Department Sales -Title "Sales Associate" -Company ACME `
  -Manager acarter `
  -AccountPassword $pw -ChangePasswordAtLogon $true -Enabled $true
Add-ADGroupMember -Identity GRP-Sales -Members lharris
```

Verification

In Active Directory:

```
Get-ADUser lharris -Properties Title,Department,Company,Manager,Enabled,PasswordExpired |
  Select-Object Name,Title,Department,Company,Manager,Enabled,PasswordExpired,DistinguishedName
Get-ADPrincipalGroupMembership lharris | Select-Object Name
```

Field	Result	Meaning
Title, Department, Company, Manager	Filled in	The Organization tab was saved
Enabled	True	The account is active
PasswordExpired	False	Captured after his first sign-in. Before it, this reads True because of the forced change.
DistinguishedName	...OU=Sales,OU=Users,OU=Acme,...	Created in the correct OU
Groups	Domain Users, GRP-Sales	Baseline access only

From the client: first sign-in and forced password change worked; `whoami /groups` lists ACME\GRP-Sales and no other department group; the Sales share opens (positive test); the Finance share is refused with a permission error (negative test).

Lessons Learned

Common failures

Symptom	Cause
"The specified user name already exists"	Logon name taken. Choose a variant.
"Password does not meet the policy requirements"	Too short or not complex enough
User signs in but gets Access denied on their own share	Group missing, or added after he signed in (he must log off and on)
New hire receives the wrong policies	Account created in the wrong OU
New hire can open a share they shouldn't	Added to an extra group, or copied from an over-privileged user
Directory fields blank after "saving"	Properties window closed without clicking **OK**

• **Access beyond the department baseline needs manager approval**, recorded in the ticket.

• **Never add anyone to privileged groups** such as Domain Admins. That is not a helpdesk decision.

• **Pass the temporary password securely**, never in plain email or chat.

• **Copying an existing user** inherits that person's groups, including any extra access. A dedicated template account holding only baseline groups is the safe version.

• **Contractors and interns** get the same steps plus an account expiry date (Account tab → *End of*).

• **Document each onboarding:** who requested it, what was created, and which groups were assigned.

Screenshots

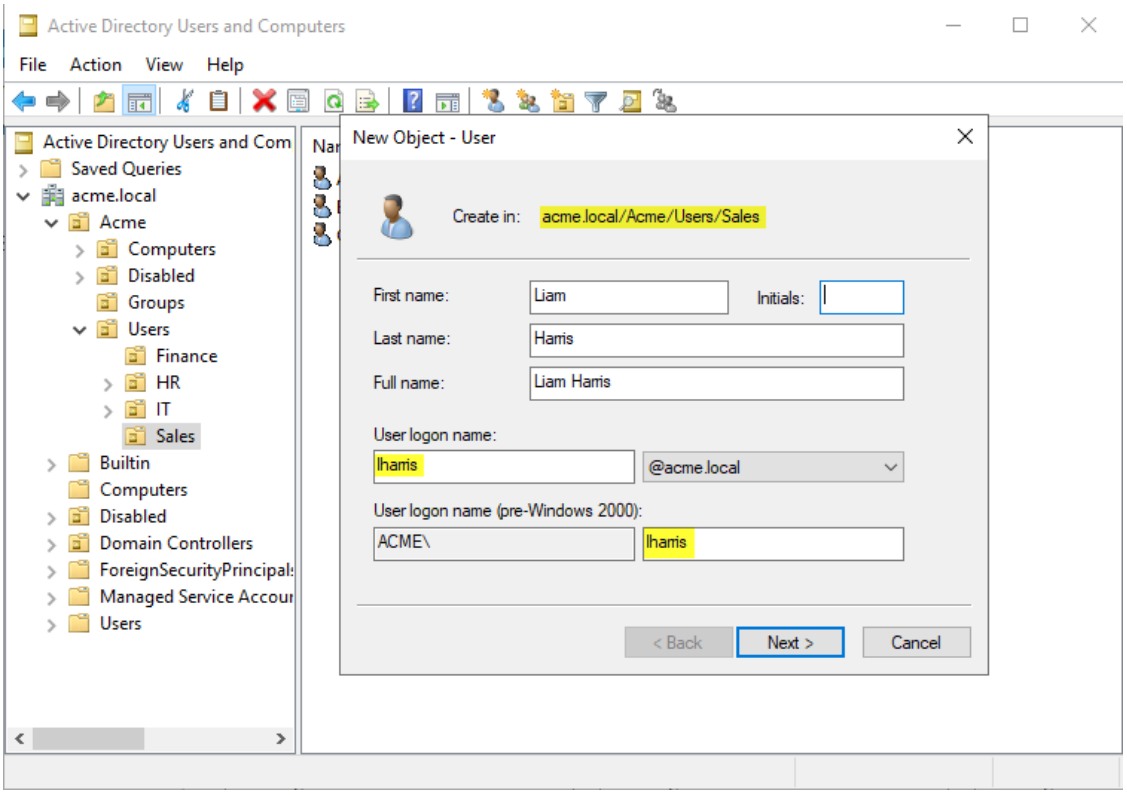


Figure 1. New user wizard: names and logon name, with the Create in path visible

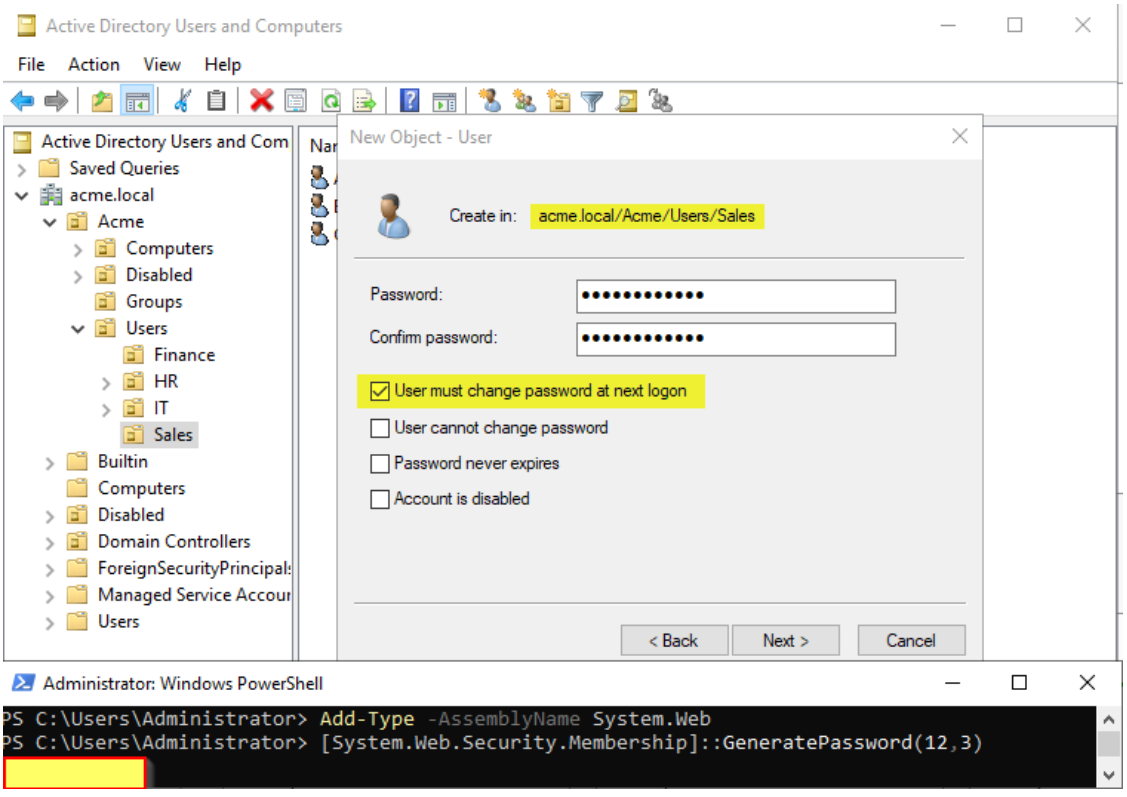


Figure 2. New user wizard: password page with the must-change option ticked

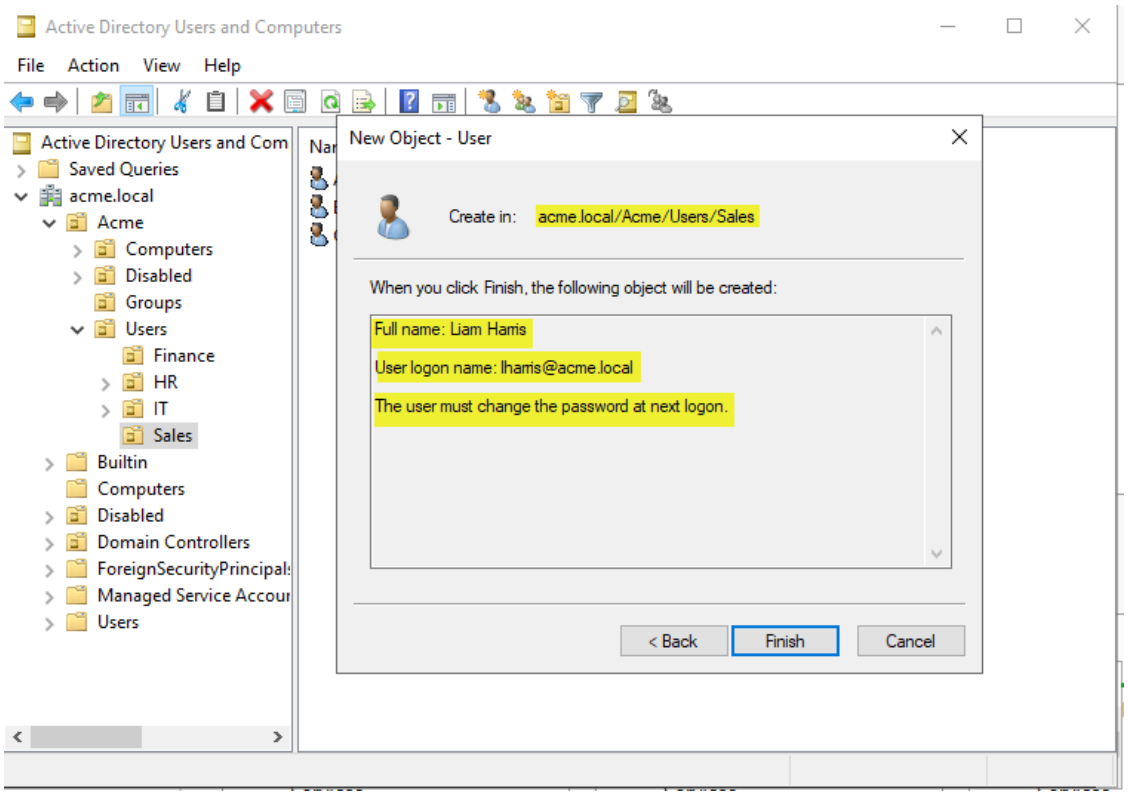


Figure 3. New user wizard: summary showing full name, logon name and forced password change

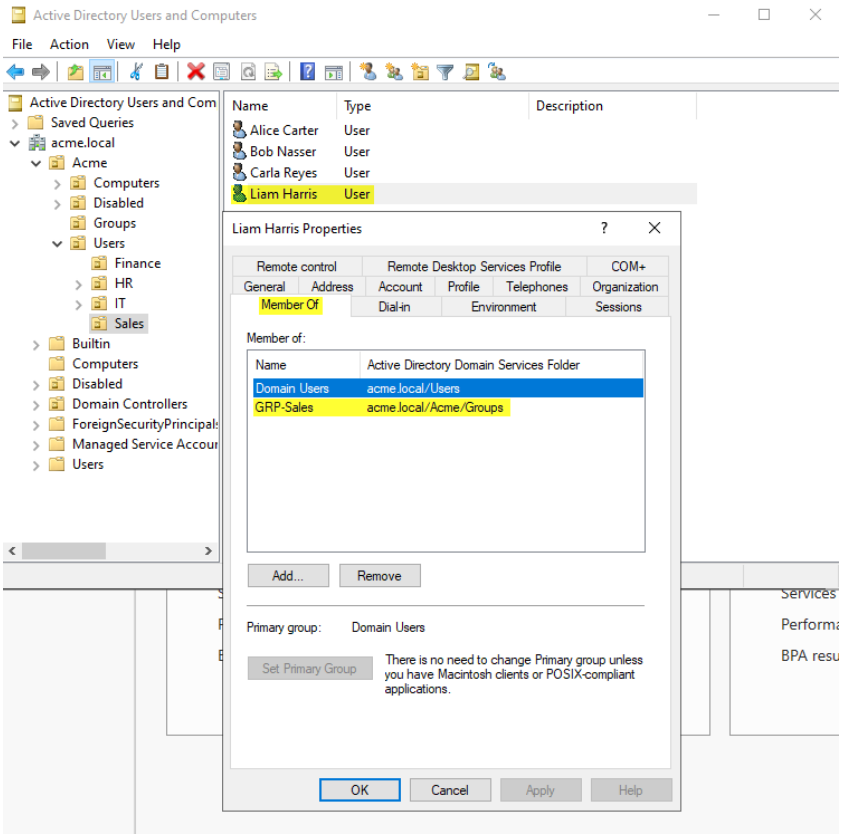


Figure 4. Member Of tab showing Domain Users and GRP-Sales

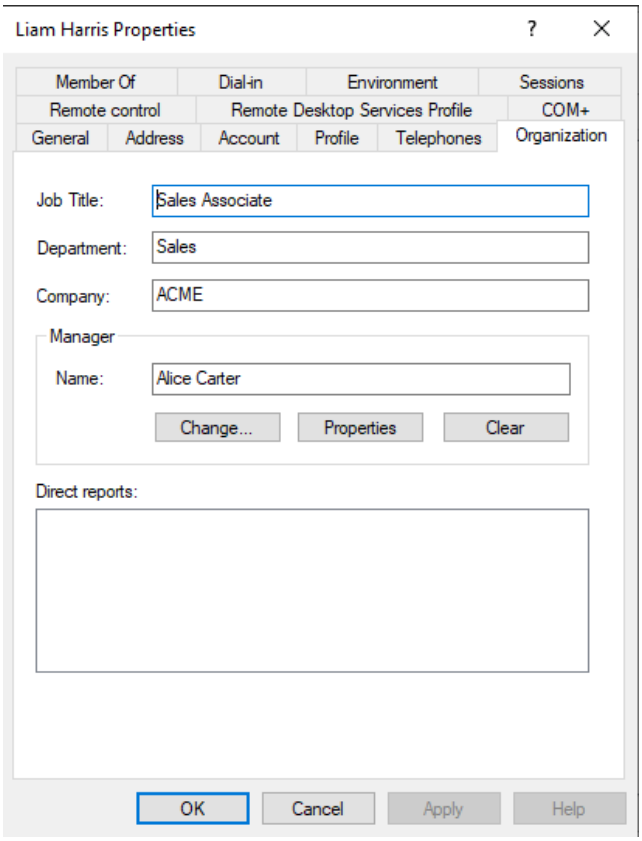


Figure 5. Organization tab with job title, department, company and manager saved

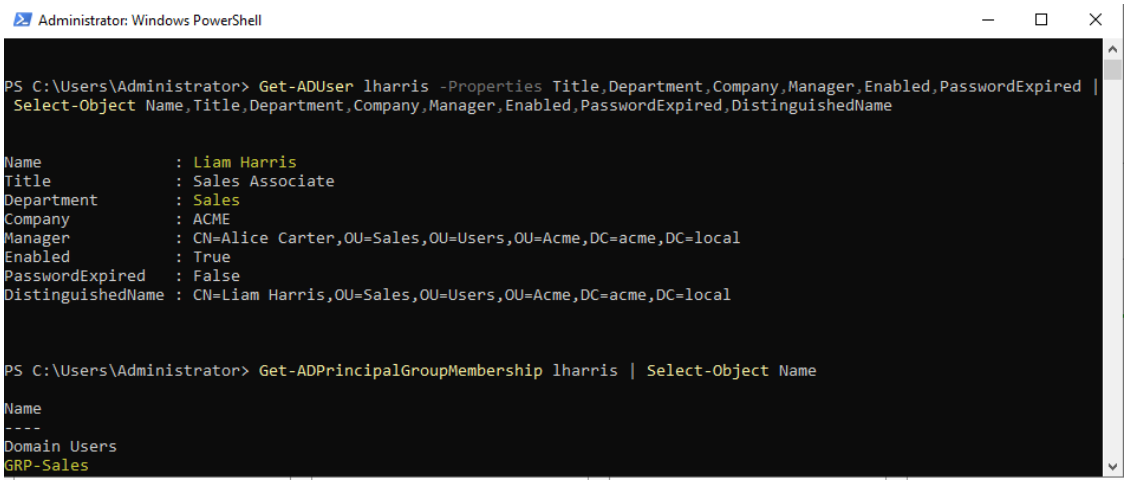


Figure 6. Get-ADUser output and group membership for lharris

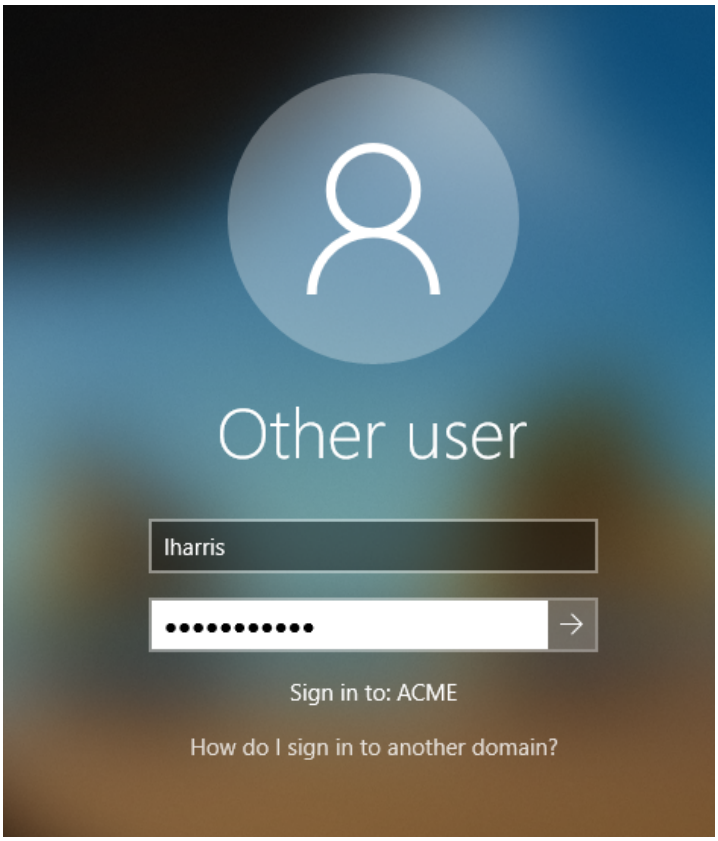


Figure 7. Sign-in screen with the temporary password entered

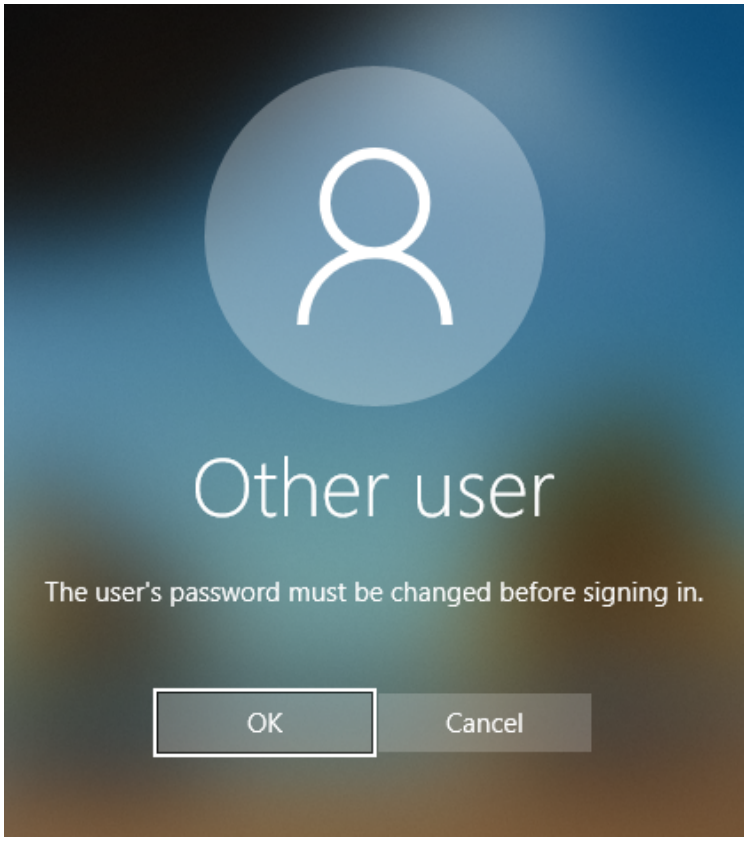


Figure 8. Prompt: the user's password must be changed before signing in

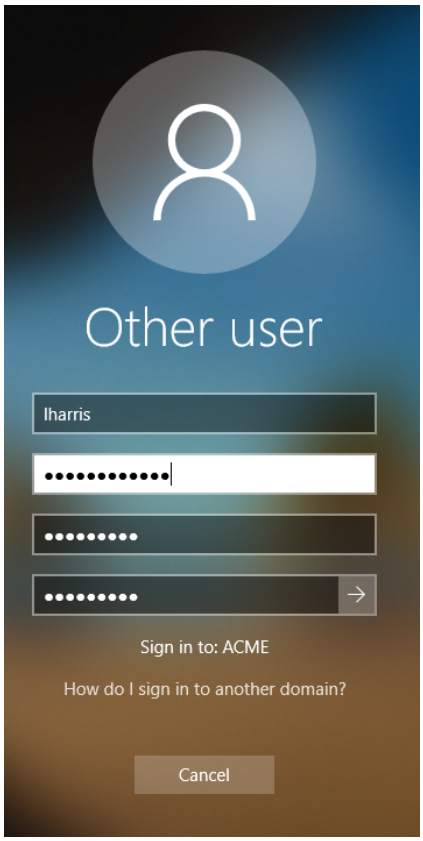


Figure 9. Change password screen: old, new and confirm fields

```
C:\Users\lharris>whoami /groups

GROUP INFORMATION
-----------------

Group Name                                 Type             SID                                            Attributes
========================================== ================ ============================================== ==================================================
Everyone                                   Well-known group S-1-1-0                                        Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
BUILTIN\Users                              Alias            S-1-5-32-545                                   Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
NT AUTHORITY\INTERACTIVE                   Well-known group S-1-5-4                                        Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
CONSOLE LOGON                              Well-known group S-1-2-1                                        Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
NT AUTHORITY\Authenticated Users           Well-known group S-1-5-11                                       Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
NT AUTHORITY\This Organization             Well-known group S-1-5-15                                       Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
LOCAL                                      Well-known group S-1-2-0                                        Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
ACME\GRP-Sales                             Group            S-1-5-21-242057048-1441979557-2913986384-1105 Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
Authentication authority asserted identity Well-known group S-1-18-1                                       Mandatory group, Enabled by default, Enabled group
Mandatory Label\Medium Mandatory Level     Label            S-1-16-8192
```

Figure 10. whoami /groups showing ACME\GRP-Sales

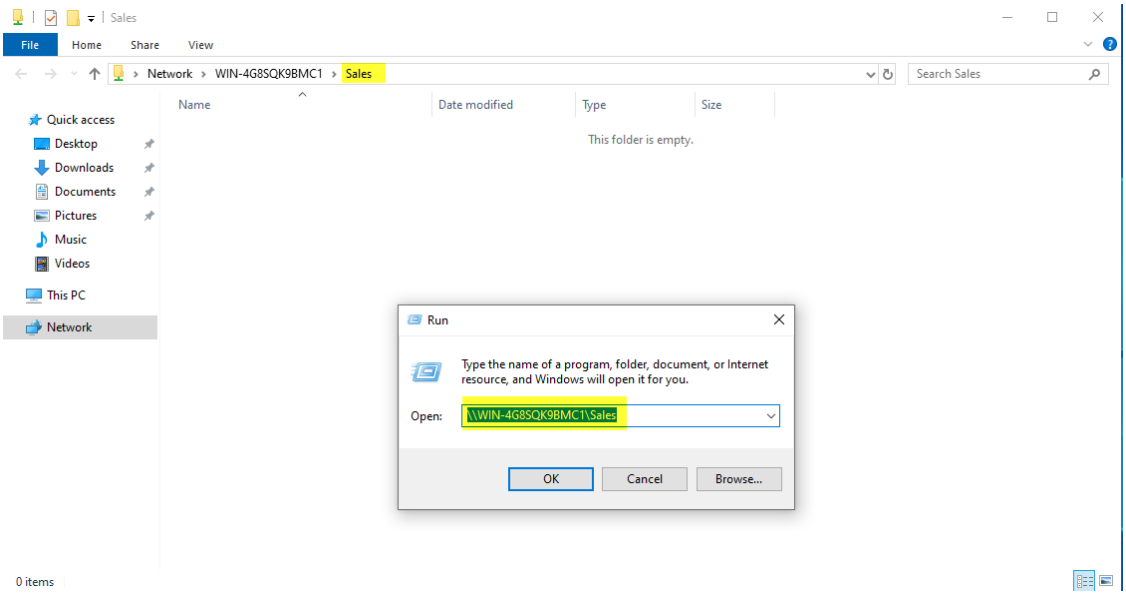


Figure 11. Sales share opened in File Explorer

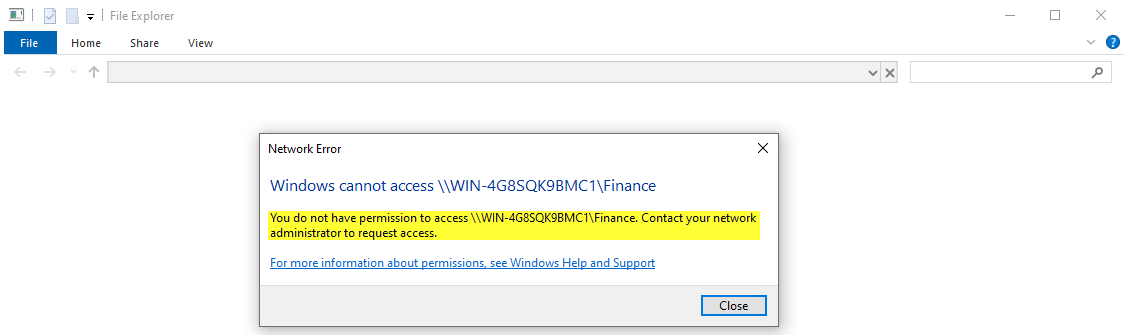


Figure 12. Network Error: you do not have permission to access the Finance share